

Prayers of Care Inc

Leadership Policy

CARF Community Integration (BH) Binder — document LEAD-01

DRAFT — no approval date, no effective date. Do not date until signed.

Nicky Ingram, Chief Executive Officer / Owner
Incorporated, CEO-led · 4–10 staff · already serving people
No medication management · no faith-based activity
Status: DRAFT — not yet adopted, not yet effective
Prepared with Successful Solutions

Document ID	LEAD-01
Version	Draft 1
Status	Draft → Approved → Trained → In use → Tested → Monitoring *(circle the current state)*
Owner	Nicky Ingram, Chief Executive Officer / Owner
Approval date	_____
Effective date	_____
Review interval	Annually
Next review due	_____
Legal entity	Prayers of Care Inc
NPI	1043895022
CARF area served	1.A Leadership (p.31)
Consultant	Successful Solutions (Tom Garner) — consultant only; not an officer or employee of Prayers of Care Inc

Confirmed: owner-operated, no board at this time · owner plus 4–10 staff · already serving people
· **no medication management offered** · no faith-based activity offered.

Purpose

Define how leadership guides Prayers of Care Inc, and make that leadership visible in writing — so that what the agency says about itself, what its records show, and what its staff say when asked all match.

Policy

Leadership of Prayers of Care Inc is responsible for:

1. **Direction** — mission, vision, values and the strategic plan.
2. **Compliance** — applicable law, NC behavioral health and Medicaid rules, payer contracts, and accreditation requirements.
3. **Quality** — safe services, rights protection, and performance improvement.
4. **Resources** — staffing, training, finances and the tools needed to deliver Community Integration through peer support.
5. **Culture** — respect, inclusion, recovery orientation, and **no retaliation** against anyone who raises a concern in good faith.

The CEO / Owner holds final accountability. Delegated leads own their assigned areas and report progress.

No leadership function is left unassigned. Where the agency is too small to have a separate person in a role, the role is assigned in writing to a named position — see ORG-01.

Procedure

A. Leadership structure

1. Maintain a current organizational chart and function assignment table — **ORG-01**.
2. Maintain a signed job description for every leadership and key role.
3. **Prayers of Care Inc is owner-operated and has no board of directors at this time.** The Owner performs the governance functions personally: approving the mission, the strategic plan and the budget; reviewing organizational performance and risk; and ensuring legal and ethical operation.
4. Because there is no board, **major decisions are recorded in the Decision Log in section G.** A decision that exists only in the Owner's memory cannot be shown to anyone.

Corporate records. Prayers of Care Inc is incorporated, with Nicky Ingram as CEO and owner. A corporation carries records a sole proprietorship does not — articles of incorporation, bylaws, the list of officers and directors, and an annual consent or minute in place of a meeting. **File copies of those in this binder.** They are the evidence behind "owner-operated, no board": a surveyor who asks how the corporation is governed should be handed the filed record, not a verbal answer.

B. Leadership meetings

1. Leadership meets **at least monthly**. With a team this size that is the Owner and the Program Supervisor; other leads attend when their area is on the agenda.
2. Every meeting has an agenda and written minutes recording **who attended, what was decided, who is responsible, and by when**.
3. At each meeting leadership reviews, at minimum:
 - performance and quality data
 - critical incidents since the last meeting
 - grievances and complaints
 - staffing, vacancies and supervision
 - progress on the improvement plan
 - progress on accreditation preparation
4. Actions are tracked to closure. An action carried unchanged across three meetings is either re-assigned with a new date or formally dropped, with the reason recorded.
5. Minutes are retained for a minimum of three years.

C. Planning

1. Maintain a written strategic plan.
2. Review it at least annually and record the review, including objectives not met and what will change.
3. Align the budget and staffing to the plan's priorities.

D. Input and transparency

1. Collect input from persons served, staff and other stakeholders.
2. Use the results in quality improvement and in planning.
3. **Tell people what changed as a result**, in plain language, within 90 days of the analysis, and record that it was distributed. Collecting input and never reporting back is the most commonly missed requirement in the whole manual.
4. Post the public notice of the CARF survey when preparing for it, so stakeholders may give input directly to CARF. Confirm the required wording and timing with your CARF resource specialist.

E. Ethics and conflicts

1. Adopt the Code of Ethics and require a signed acknowledgment from every employee, contractor, student, intern and volunteer at hire and annually.
2. Disclose and manage conflicts of interest in writing.
3. **Owner-specific:** where the Owner has a personal, family or financial interest in a decision — a vendor, a landlord, a hire, a referral relationship — it is disclosed in the Decision Log and the reasoning recorded, even though there is no board to abstain from.

F. Delegation, backup and non-retaliation

1. Dual roles and backups are recorded in writing in ORG-01, not held in anyone's memory.
2. **Someone must be able to cover if the CEO is unavailable.** Backup for the CEO / Owner: `[FILL IN — name and role]`
3. At least two people can reach the record system, the bank, the payer portals, the building and the alarm. Where only the Owner can do something, it is recorded as a known risk.
4. **A concern about the Owner must have somewhere to go that is not the Owner.** The route is recorded in ORG-01 section 5 and is printed on the Rights handout given to every person served. Staff and persons served are told about it, not left to work it out.

G. Decision Log — required because there is no board

Every decision a board would have minuted goes here instead: adopting or changing a policy, approving the budget, taking on or ending a payer contract, hiring or ending a leadership role, changing the services offered, responding to a serious incident, and any decision where the Owner had a personal interest.

Date	Decision	Why	Who was consulted	Conflict of interest declared?	Where the supporting document is filed
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Who holds what

The authoritative list is the function assignment table in ORG-01. It is deliberately not repeated here — two lists of who-does-what in two documents will drift apart, and a surveyor who finds them disagreeing has found a real problem.

Overall leadership	Nicky Ingram, Chief Executive Officer / Owner
Everything else	See ORG-01, section 1

Annual review record

Review due	Completed (date)	Reviewed by	Changes made, or "reviewed, no change"	New version
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Adoption

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Chief Executive Officer / Owner	Nicky Ingram	_____	_____
Program Supervisor	`[FILL IN]`	_____	_____

What a surveyor will ask

They ask	They are testing	What has to be true
"Show me twelve months of leadership meeting minutes."	Whether leadership meets or just exists	Minutes with decisions, owners and dates — not attendance lists
"You have no board. How do you record major decisions?"	1.A / 1.B for an owner-operated agency	The Decision Log, with real entries
"Who is accountable for quality?"	Named accountability	A name
"What did you decide last month, and what happened?"	Whether actions close	A decision traced to a completed action
"If someone had a concern about you, where would it go?"	Non-retaliation, 1.J	A route that does not run through the Owner, that staff can name
Asked of a peer specialist : "how does leadership hear about problems?"	Whether the culture matches the policy	Their answer matches this document

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